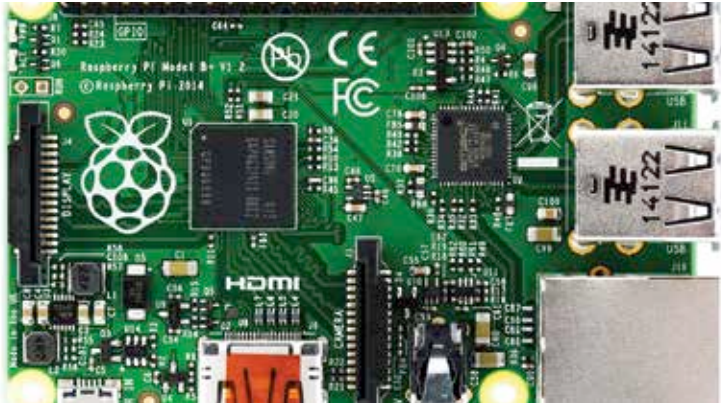




Raspberry B+, the first upgrade to the raspberry B model

At its initiation, the Raspberry Pi was as basic as basic could be. And once you had one, setting it up wasn't difficult either. You could plug in your Mouse and Keyboard to the USB slots, your headphones or speakers to the audio slot, your display and network to the HDMI and Ethernet respectively, and then fire it all up by powering it through the Micro-USB slot with a cable of your own. When it comes to software though, there are a few considerations to be made. Since the Raspberry Pi didn't boast of any onboard memory, the only recourse was the Memory card slot. This basically meant you would have to load a bootable version of an OS onto an SD card and plug it in.

Windows was out of the question, due to its size and incompatibility with ARM chips. As recommended by the official Raspberry Pi website, certain Linux distros could be used instead: the Debian Squeeze, the Arch-Linux ARM and the Qton Pi, and then write (not copy) it onto the SD card. This wasn't much different than booting up a normal Windows/Linux PC. (Although eventually, a Debian derivative called Raspbian would make its way to the Pi 1 as well)

Once it is set up, the initial command line view might be daunting to many. But it is actually the easiest way to do certain tasks like setting the time (which is important because the Pi doesn't have an onboard battery to track that). And for those who are strictly looking for a GUI, all they need to do is install the right software.

Even if one messed up with this, there are sufficient resources online including a robust online community and an official forum to help them